Manas Talukdar

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Manas Talukdar is a senior industry leader in enterprise AI and data infrastructure with nearly two decades of experience. He has made key contributions to the preeminent process data historian in the world. He has held leadership roles at multiple companies, building and leading organizations developing large-scale AI and data products used globally. He is a senior member of IEEE, an AI senior fellow, and advisory board/council member. He mentors startups and industry professionals, and often speaks at conferences. Manas has also been invited to judge prestigious industry awards and review technical publications. He has filed several patents in AI and Data. His contributions have been recognized through numerous honors, awards and invitations to join prestigious AI organizations.

Education

North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC, *Master of Science, Electrical Engineering* — Aug 2005 – May 2007

Gauhati University, Assam, India, *Bachelor of Engg., Electrical Engg.*, Dean's List - 5 semesters — Aug 2000 – June 2004

Recent Experience

Director of Engineering, Labelbox, San Francisco, CA — Feb 2024 – present

AI Platform (Feb 2024 – present)

- Supporting platform, product and machine learning engineering organizations in US and EU building a data-centric AI platform and AI SaaS products.
- Initiatives in RLHF, SFT. ML model (LLM) evaluation / fine-tuning / experimentation, data IO / processing, platform resiliency, etc.

Director of Engineering, C3 AI, Redwood City, CA — Dec 2022 – Feb 2024

Data Infrastructure, AI/ML Platform (Dec 2022 - Feb 2024)

- Manager of managers. Supported org of 6 teams building multi-cloud, distributed data infra PaaS for large-scale AI/ML applications.
- Leading new initiatives critical for the company, broadly at the intersection of large-scale distributed systems, data infrastructure and machine learning.
- Wide impact involving improvements in data ingestion performance for the AI Platform by orders of magnitude, building a new data exploration product that enables data scientists to be productive from day 1 by abstracting exploration, workflow and execution (engines), design and development of a novel metadata based feature store for machine learning, etc.
- Specific initiatives include data integration, data exploration and productionization, feature store, vector stores for GenAI, AI/ML application development tooling, etc.
- Helped create new intellectual property leading to patents.

Senior Engineering Manager, C3 AI, Redwood City, CA — Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

Data Infrastructure, AI/ML Platform (Jan 2022 - Dec 2022)

- Grew the Data org from 3 to 5 teams.
- Responsible for key initiatives and new products in data infrastructure, distributed computing, ML, dev tooling for AI/ML application development and metadata-driven ML-based extensible UI framework.
- Established structures across org for growth and retention - rotation across teams, project time, etc.
- Drove growth for org by mentoring employees into key roles in both individual contributor and management track, hiring high-impact talent and resource planning for initiatives.
- Drove growth across department by hiring individual contributors and recruiting engineering managers.
- Coached new engineering managers into hiring and growth methodologies.
- Started a newsletter for sharing technical information and departmental updates.

Engineering Manager, C3 AI, Redwood City, CA — Jan 2020 – Dec 2021

Data Infrastructure, AI/ML Platform (Jan 2020 - Dec 2021)

- Established the Data org within Platform engineering department. Grew a team of 6 to an org ~20 engineers across 3 teams building multi-cloud, distributed data infrastructure Platform-as-a-Service (Paas) for large-scale AI/ML applications. Defined charter for each team. Identified, mentored and promoted senior engineers to lead roles for each team. Drove further growth across department. Established a new interviewing framework. Worked with Talent Acquisition to streamline hiring process.
- Ensured delivery of high-impact projects.
- Led performance benchmarking initiative against industry solution(s).
- As part of department leadership refined expected signals and attributes for each role and level in individual contributor track. Instituted a framework for promoting engineers, specially to lead role.
- Started data-driven performance analysis across engineering department for developers and teams, mining data from Jira, GitHub, Git, etc. Instituted a 360° feedback framework.
- Started a regular Lunch and Learn initiative across org for knowledge sharing and translation of tribal knowledge into technical documentation.

Engineering Manager, OSIsoft, LLC., San Leandro, CA Jan 2016 – Jan 2020

PaaS, SaaS Product (Metadata Solution) (Feb 2019 - Jan 2020) [https://bit.ly/2FZfzED]

- Managed and grew a team working on large-scale distributed Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) and Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) metadata solutions for storage and analysis of high-throughput streaming process data to enable asset management using context for industrial applications. Context involves models, hierarchies, objects, for equipment and data, as a single repository.
- Led team through successful completion of program for enabling data science on streaming data by automated generation of metadata using rules.
- Responsible for hiring, mentoring developers, performance reviews, 1-1's, sprint velocity and overall team health.
- Product owner. Worked closely with cross-functional stakeholders (Product and Program Managers, Architects) to manage product backlog and drive road-map.
- Managed dependencies across multiple teams and guided the team with design and architecture decisions.

Event Notifications Product (Feb 2019 - Jan 2020) [https://bit.ly/3uNi84j]

- Worked with product manager to roll out fixes on an as-needed basis and managed developer escalation.

IoT Product (May 2017 - Jan 2019) [https://bit.ly/3nOpaS0]

- Started new team for project on large-scale, enterprise-wide, high-throughput streaming data collection from IoT devices. Interviewed candidates for hiring into the team. Gathered requirements and defined product direction in collaboration with product management, group lead and customers.
- Motivated using Git for source control. Developed an administration API with back-end and front-end. Developed a logging infrastructure. Developed mechanism for high-throughput streaming data egress from IoT module to enterprise data storage solutions for both real-time and historical data.

PaaS Product (Storage Solution; Core Platform and Infrastructure) (Jan 2016 - April 2017) [https://bit.ly/2FZfzED]

- Founded and grew a team of software developers working on multi-tenant distributed Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) solution. Recruited and on-boarded developers into team. Drove software engineering best practices, including agile methodologies. Took project from prototype to product. Ran sprints, assisted developers with tasks and enabled team to accomplised goals. Developed a caching service - passed on to developers in the team. Created a high-value engineering team that developed high-visibility, large-scale distributed data platform product which spawned next-generation series of enterprise software solutions.
- Defined system architecture for a cloud-native distributed Sequential Data Store PaaS solution to ingest, process, store, analyze, query, share billions of (real-time and historical) streams from millions of industrial devices and Internet-of-Things (IoT) sensors. Collaborated cross-functionally with customers, product managers and engineering architect to identify requirements and develop road-map.
- Managed all aspects of the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC). Introduced CI/CD. Researched new partner technologies and provided feedback. Presented at meetings and conferences.

Prior Experience

Senior Software Developer, OSIsoft, LLC., San Leandro, CA — Feb 2015 – Jan 2016

PaaS Product (Storage Solution; Core Platform and Infrastructure) [https://bit.ly/2FZfzED]

- Architected and developed scalable, distributed micro-services using new cloud technology – Service Fabric.
- Security champion for team. Threat modeled components and data flow in the project and led review sessions.
- Architected full-stack real-time observability (health monitoring and logging) systems with data access and client APIs.
- Interviewed, on-boarded and mentored new engineers in project.

Software Developer, OSIsoft, LLC., San Leandro, CA — May 2011 – Jan 2015

PaaS, SaaS R&D Project (Storage Solution; Core Platform and Infrastructure) (June 2014 - Jan 2015) [https://bit.ly/2FZfzED]

- Founding team member and lead developer in charge of creating core platform, infrastructure for distributed streaming-data Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) and Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) solutions.
- Developed components of multi-tenant distributed data store.
- Added data replication functionality leveraging leader-election and distributed consensus algorithms.
- Developed automated multi-threaded chaos tests. Created standards for DevOps - passed on to other engineers.
- Mentored new engineer in developing a real-time health monitoring framework.

SaaS Product (Feb 2013 - June 2014) [https://bit.ly/3liljOb]

- Part of team that developed first cloud product at OSIsoft.
- Developed front-end and back-end components of cloud-based enterprise SaaS product for process data transfers.
- Developed secure RESTful APIs. Did threat modeling of cloud services and corresponding on-prem components.
- Architected and developed an alarm infrastructure.
- Designed and developed a cloud-based software management, delivery and auto-update system.
- Enhanced SQL database schema and developed full stack from server-side data-access layer to client-side APIs.
- Developed DevOps tools and data-mining queries for reporting on health statuses of multi-tenant cloud application.
- Developed multi-layered modular and scalable WPF applications.
- Consistently delivered committed items in fast-paced, quick turn-around, scrum-based development cycles. Led knowledge transfer sessions to handover work to new team member(s) while transitioning to a R&D project.

Middleware (SDK) Product (May 2011 - Feb 2013) [https://bit.ly/3rvmxqC]

- Developed and maintained test automation frameworks. Developed and maintained software delivery systems using Wise and WiX. Enhanced and maintained codebase (specifically data buffering) for core middleware.
- Worked with uses in Fortune 500 companies through multiple successful releases.

QA Engineer, OSIsoft, LLC., San Leandro, CA — July 2008 – April 2011

- Architected and developed (automated) test systems for multiple products, reducing release cycle testing time, using C++, .NET, SQL, test automation tools like SilkTest and OOP based UI automation tools.
- Worked with senior developers on middleware code for core product.

Engineer, Rotational Engineering Program, OSIsoft, LLC., San Leandro, CA — July 2007 – June 2008

- Resolved OSIsoft PI software issues and went on site visits to configure and troubleshoot PI Software.
- Improved effectiveness of software health metrics by 92%. Delivered proof-of-concept projects that led to new sales.
- Developed automated test frameworks.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, ECE Dept., NCSU, Raleigh, NC — Jan 2007 – May 2007

- Graded assignments, administered website, answered questions and was instructor for semester project related classes in a controls course.

Graduate Research Assistant, ADAC Lab, ECE Dept., NCSU, Raleigh, NC — Aug 2006 – Dec 2006

- Surveyed publications, wrote portions of research project proposals and reviewed IEEE proceeding submissions.
- Mathematically modeled and simulated a formation controller for mobile robots over a wireless network.

Summer Session Teaching Assistant, ADAC Lab, ECE Dept., NCSU, Raleigh, NC — May 2006 – July 2006

- Developed an embedded micro-controller software library and maintained a slew of mobile robots.

- Supervised, mentored and graded students for term projects in programming, mechatronics, controls.
- Created new labs and instructed a class of 85 students for experiments in a mechatronics graduate level course.

Specialist Customer Support, IBM, Daksh e-Services Private Limited, India — Jan 2005 – March 2005

- Resolved broadband internet connectivity issues with overseas customers.
- Worked with real-time databases to update connectivity status.

Summer Intern, Control and Instrumentation, NEEPCO, AGBPP, India — July 2003 – Aug 2003

- Involved in upgrade of a 33.5 MW turbine-generator control unit at NEEPCO, a $35 billion power company.
- Obtained field experience in power systems, generation, electrical machines.

Publications

- R. Vanijjirattikhan, M. Talukdar, and M-Y. Chow, "Accumulated Effect Parameter Tuning Method for Geometrical Path Tracking of Wheeled Mobile Robots", *in the proceedings of the IEEE/ASME International Conference on Advanced Intelligent Mechatronics*, Zurich, September 2007.

Skills

Management

- Organizational growth, engineering productivity.
- Agile methodologies (scrum, kanban), backlog management, requirements analysis, collaborating with users, product, services, support, etc.
- People management, 1-1s, performance reviews, career development, performance improvement plans, on-boarding.

Computing

- Artificial intelligence, machine learning, PaaS, SaaS, large-scale distributed systems, cloud computing, data infrastructure, micro-services, IoT, APIs, SDKs, multi-threading, service-oriented architecture, web services, data modeling, software threat modeling.
- Data structures, algorithms, design patterns, systems design.
- **Languages:** Very comfortable: Java, C#. Comfortable: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript. Learning: Go. Academics, early career: C/C++, SQL.
- **Data Infrastructure:** SQL, NoSQL, OSIsoft PI.
- **Architectural Constructs:** REST, MVVM, MVC.
- **Frameworks:** Angular, Vue.js, Reactjs. Node.js, .NET, ASP.NET, WPF, WiX toolset.
- **Tools:** VSCode, Visual Studio, IntelliJ, Jira, Confluence.
- **Systems:** Git.
- **Microsoft Azure:** Service Fabric, AppInsights, Event Hubs, Blobs, IoT, VMs, DevOps, etc.
- **Amazon Web Services (AWS):** S3, IAM, EC2, RDS, DynamoDB, EMR, AutoScaling, SQS, SNS, API Gateway, Lambda, etc.
- **Google Cloud Platform (GCP)**

Languages: Fluent in Hindi, Assamese (North East Indian language). Elementary Bengali. Basic Sanskrit.

Patents

Data Processing and Machine Learning for AI

- Intelligent data processing system with metadata generation from iterative data analysis [Filed].
- Intelligent data processing system with multi-interface frontend and backend [Filed].
- Metadata-driven feature store for machine learning systems [Filed].

Professional Engagements

Professional Memberships and Affiliations

- Member of the American Society for AI.
- Member of the Harvard Business Review Advisory Council.
- Member and Ambassador at the AI Frontier Network.
- Member of the AI Accelerator Institute.
- Member of the MIT Technology Review Global Insights Panel.
- Senior member of IEEE.

Fellowships

- Senior Fellow of AI 2030.

Board Memberships

- Advisory Board member of AI 2030.

Judging Roles

- Judge for Globee Awards.
- Judge for American Business Awards (part of the Stevie Awards).
- Accepted as judge for Titan Business Awards.
- Accepted as judge for 2024 SIIA CODiE Awards.

Editor and Reviewer Roles

- Technical Editor and Reviewer for Manning Publications.

Advisory Roles

- Mentor/Advisor for startups at Alchemist Accelerator, a venture backed accelerator for early-stage startups that monetize from enterprises.
- Engineering leadership mentor at Plato.
- AI/ML, career development, technology and leadership mentor at MentorCruise.
- Technology advisor for AI, ML, distributed systems, etc. at Guidepoint, Office Hours, Capvision.

Speaking Engagements

- Frequent speaker at engineering and leadership conferences on AI, Data, etc.
- Often lead or participate in roundtables and panel discussions.
- Delivered graduation speech on AI at university commencement ceremonies.

Volunteering

Mentoring

- Engineering mentor, specifically around AI/ML, at ADPList.
- Engineering and leadership mentor at The Mentoring-Club.
- Mentor at The Mentoring Club.

Honors

- **Invited to be listed in Marquis Who's Who, July 2024.**

> “Marquis Who's Who was established in 1898 and promptly began publishing biographical data in 1899. More than 125 years ago, our founder, Albert Nelson Marquis, established a standard of excellence with the first publication of Who's Who in America.”

> “A biographical dictionary of notable men and women, first published in 1899 which highlights thousands of biographies that reach beyond lists and facts to shed additional light on what makes these inspiring individuals who they are. Among our listees are Nobel and Pulitzer Prize winners, legendary athletes, best-selling authors, accomplished artists, renowned entertainers, entrepreneurs, corporate executives, and more.”

- **Invited to be a member of the American Society for AI (ASFAI), July 2024.**

> American Society for Artificial Intelligence (ASFAI) is a private & prestigious club that brings together prominent leaders & executives. ... Membership is reserved for established leaders and executives, C-Suite and Senior-level, and includes a robust vetting process and with Board approval. Members are of diverse backgrounds and industries; including pioneers in AI, entrepreneurs, executives, technologists, philanthropists, authors, investors, lawyers, policymakers, researchers, computer scientists, engineers, doctors, and professors.

- **Invited to be an Ambassador at the AI Frontier Network, May 2024.**

> The AI Frontier Network (AIFN) invites renowned thought leaders and change makers to join as Ambassadors, catalyzing the artificial intelligence revolution. This select group have distinguished themselves as leaders and innovators pioneering new frontiers in the age of AI.

> AIFN Ambassadors are members who have distinguished themselves as leaders and innovators pioneering new frontiers in the age of AI. The group includes CEOs, entrepreneurs, authors, speakers, engineers, and tech leaders driving innovation... They bring a wealth of expertise and vision from their roles, driving growth and collaboration within the AI Frontier Network.

- **IEEE Senior Membership. Issued by IEEE, August 2023.** *IEEE senior membership requires extensive experience and reflects professional maturity. It is based on a detailed scrutiny of documented and sustained achievements and is bestowed only to those who have consistently made significant contributions to the profession.*
- Successfully completed a 5-year diploma from **Assam Fine Arts and Crafts Society**, India.
- Performance in Science and Mathematics in All India Secondary School Examination in the top 1/8th.
- Successfully qualified in All-India Mathematics Olympiad conducted by Delhi Association of Mathematics Teachers.

Awards

- **International Business Award (Stevie). Innovator of the Year - Issued by International Business Awards®, August 2024.** *Manas Talukdar has been honored with a Gold Stevie® Award as "Innovator of the Year" in the "Management" category in The 21st Annual International Business Awards® for "Innovations and Leadership in AI and Data".*
- **Globee Award for Technology. Professional of the Year | Artificial Intelligence - Issued by Globee Business Awards, June 2024.** *Manas Talukdar was recognized with a Globee Award for Technology in the category of "Artificial Intelligence Achievement of the Year", for Innovative product development in AI with patents and wide adoption. This recognition underscores the entrant's distinguished performance, creativity, and impact within their sector, highlighting them as high achievers.*
- **Globee Award for Technology. Artificial Intelligence Achievement of the Year - Issued by Globee Business Awards, June 2024.** *Manas Talukdar was recognized with a Globee Award for Technology in the category of "Artificial Intelligence Achievement of the Year", for Innovative product development in AI with patents and wide adoption. This recognition underscores the entrant's distinguished performance, creativity, and impact within their sector, highlighting them as high achievers.*
- **Titan Business Award. Issued by Titan Awards, May 2024.** *Manas Talukdar was recognized with a 2024 Titan Business Award in the category of "Executives & Professionals - Innovator of the Year" for leadership and innovations in AI with patents and adoption.*
- **Global Recognition Award. Issued by Global Recognition Awards, March 2024.** *Manas Talukdar has been recognized with a 2024 Global Recognition Award for his exceptional contributions and achievements in the field of artificial intelligence and large-scale data infrastructure.*
- **Indian Achiever's Award. Issued by Indian Achievers' Forum, March 2024.** *We extend our heartfelt congratulations to Mr. Manas Talukdar for receiving the prestigious Indian Achievers' Award 2023-24. This recognition is a testament to his outstanding achievements and remarkable contributions towards Science & Technology.*

Media Coverage

- Manas Talukdar - Industry Leader Driving Innovations And Global Adoption In AI And Data Infrastructure [Outlook India] [July 4, 2024].
- Manas Talukdar, Director of Engineering at Labelbox - Driving Innovation in AI: Harnessing Multi-Modal Language Models to Transform Enterprise Solutions and Redefine Customer Interactions Across Industries. An interview with Flor Laorga for AI Time Journal [June 18, 2024].
- Manas Talukdar Of Labelbox: How AI Is Disrupting Our Industry, and What We Can Do About It. An Interview with Cynthia Corsetti for Authority Magazine [June 13, 2024].
- Manas Talukdar Wins a 2024 Global Recognition Award™ [Marketers Media] [May 4, 2024].
- Manas Talukdar Wins a 2024 Global Recognition Award™ [Business Insider] [May 6, 2024].